

MYLAPORE

Mandaveli » R A Puram » Royapettah » Chindatripet » Royapuram » Korukkupet » Ennore » Luz » Alwarpet » Triplicane » Central

Washermenpet » Tondiarpet » Manali » M.R.C.Nagar » Teynampet » Mount Road » Broadway » Kondithope » Tiruvotiyur



FREE SESSION ON ROBOTIC SURGERY TODAY

This session is designed for the general public and does not require any prior medical knowledge **P3**



A SECOND CHANCE FOR EVERYDAY THINGS

A close look at Chennai's repair culture provides cause for some celebration and also reasons to revitalise efforts to promote it **P6**



These images were taken on June 13, immediately after the crash.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A scary thud at Thiruvengadam Street

On June 13, an old tree, reportedly unsteady for a long time, crashed damaging a compound wall, a car inside and two other cars outside. Fortunately, no one was injured

D. VINOTHKUMAR

On the morning of June 13, a little past 8.30 a.m., fear came crashing into Dr. M. Thanigai Vandan's house on Thiruvengadam Street in RK Nagar in a thud of branches and leaves. Fortunately, there was no damage to limb, not a scratch. But the sight of a huge tree, an old Flame of the Forest, breaking their compound wall and damaging their car left the residents shell-shocked. They were clearly scarred in the mind.

Two cars parked on the street were also damaged.

This tree had been standing in a private property at RK Nagar Second Cross Street close to its junction with Thiruvengadam Street.

Dr. Thanigai Vandan notes he had earlier informed Greater Chennai Corporation about the state of the tree and wanted it removed, but the word of caution was ignored.



June 13 happened to be a holiday; one shudders to think of a scenario where people had been walking by at the time of the tree crash, coming under its earth-bound course.

Nearby on Thiruvengadam Street, a school is located. This should serve as a warning to Greater Chennai Corporation that it should act promptly on complaints about unsteady trees.

D. Vinothkumar is a resident of RK Nagar Second Cross Street

Make **Creativity** part of their routine!

Back To School Offer

Enrol Now

Get a 3D Pencil Pouch worth **Rs.400 FREE**

Limited Period Offer
*Offer Valid till 30th June 2026

Why Globalart?

- Builds focus & Patience
- Boosts confidence & self-expression
- Encourages creative thinking beyond textbooks

India's Largest International Creative Art Programme for Children

International Presence

To book a **FREE Experience Class**
Globalart Area **95662 62366 / 97890 64783**

Keshavaperumalpuram South resident, Pandian, latches on to his magazine store despite dwindling sales

PRINCE FREDERICK

No, Pandian does not follow Insta trends that romanticise the tactility of physical books, the incredible idea of holding thoughts in your hand before dropping them into your brain. Putting it in grander terms, the sacred union of the sensory and the cerebral. He does not canonise physical books writing digital hagiographies to them and canonising them into sainthood through posts on social media handles. No book apps to his name; not a single one. In fact he does the unthinkable: he carries no phone with him. When a quizical brow running the gamut of questions (why, how come, why not, since when?) is directed at him, his answer is unhurried and accompanied by a gesture (palms covering his head): “The mobile phone is a headache”. He says



Betting big on print

that in Tamil. Who is this “mystery man” Pandian anyway? His bio at the press of a button, nay the flipping of pages.

Seventy-five years old. Formal education ending with Class VII. A resident of Keshavaperumalpu-

ram South in R.A. Purim. His work space is in Besant Nagar, at the cusp of Besant Avenue Road and Second Besant Avenue Road, the space lying strategically on the path to the Besant Nagar bus terminus. He is modest to a fault,

Pandian at his newspaper mart in Besant Nagar.



caring a hoot about winning people over with appearances: his work flannels are just a banian paired with a dhoti. But he ends up winning people over with a quiet confidence, even unintended chutzpah, the courage to not bend oneself to trends. He displays all of these by holding on to what is now a 45-year-long metier and title: seller of magazines and newspapers. He has retained the visible symbol of this engagement, a newspaper and magazine mart, the eponymous ASP Newspaper Mart, stubbornly staying put in its corner despite progressively decreasing footfall. The establishment is modest: an old, pushcart painted in blue shaded from the shine and rain with a corrugated metal sheet and tarpaulin. By the side of the cart, stand two slanting paper and ma-

gazine metal racks.

The collection of magazines is as ambitious as the establishment is spartan. The Hollywood Reporter; Vogue; Conde Nast Traveller; Autocar; TopGear; Outlook Traveller; Entrepreneur; Brides Today; Frontline; Architecture + Design; Dalal Street Investment Journal and so on. There are English, Tamil, Malayalam and Hindi magazines and newspapers. “After the pandemic, sales had been on a low. People who read magazines are in a decline. There are some old people are left. Gen Zs go abroad (yes, he used the descriptor Gen Z),” states Pandian, not in a rueful tone, but in a manner that suggests dispassionate reporting. But that has not caused him to do a rethink about the business. To questions about financial viability of this enterprise, he points out he does not bother about it at all, just sells those newspapers and magazines; and a few other items (disposable razor, tongue cleaner and so) that “rats cannot get at”. And he seems to sell just enough to keep the show going. His self-identity is incredibly entangled in the notion of a newspaper seller, and he cannot disentangle himself from it without causing a dent in his self-worth.

READERS WRITE

New speed breaker near Nageswara Rao park is not as per norms



BASKAR SESHADRI

The new speed breaker near Aavin junction and Nageswara Rao park in Mylapore has not been laid as per Indian Road Congress norms. It is a risk for motorcyclists, especially those taking this stretch at night. I hope this one is removed and a new one with reflective sign mark installed in its place.

‘Close TASMAC outlets near Vysarpadi bus stand, school’

DHIVYA SARAVANAN

Despite the Tamil Nadu government’s order to shut down TASMAC shops (717 of them were identified) located within 500 metres of schools, colleges, temples, bus stands, and other public places, two TASMAC shops in Vysarpadi that meet the criteria on a count or two, continue undisturbed. One TASMAC outlet is located near Vysarpadi Bus Stand and the other, near a nursery school.

For several years, local residents, commuters, shop owners, and women passengers have faced problems due to these TASMAC shops. During the evening and late-night hours, groups of drunken people often gather near the bus stand, nursery school surroundings, creating a sense of discomfort and fear.

Local shop owners have said that many customers, especially women, avoid visiting nearby shops because of the disturbances around the TASMAC outlets. Residents have repeatedly submitted petitions and complaint letters to the powers that be, but in vain.



PLAN YOUR WEEK



RAPRA organising free session on robotic surgery today

This session is designed for the general public and does not require any prior medical knowledge, says a press release shared by the residents association from R.A. Puram

Robotic technology is increasingly being used in hospitals to perform a wide range of surgical procedures for its greater precision, smaller incisions, reduced pain and faster recovery. However, many patients and caregivers are still unfamiliar with this advanced medical technology. A press release says that to create awareness and provide reliable information to the public, Raja Annamalaipuram Residents Association (RAPRA) in association with City Union Bank is organising an expert talk titled “All About Ro-

botic Surgery” on June 14 at 11:00 a.m. The venue is R.K. Mansion City Union Bank Training College Auditorium, No. 7, Third Cross Street, R.A. Puram.

The speaker is Dr. S. Ananthakrishnan, M.S., DNB, M.Ch (Urology), FRCS (Urology), Fellowship in Robotic Urology, Florida, USA, and Managing Director, Curi Hospital, Rajiv Gandhi Salai, Chennai. Dr. Ananthakrishnan is a leading expert in robotic surgery and has successfully performed numerous robotic surgical procedures, says the press release, adding that this ses-

sion is designed for the general public and does not require any prior medical knowledge. The speaker will explain the fundamentals of robotic surgery in simple, easy-to-understand language and discuss its benefits, applications, limitations and future potential.

An interactive question-and-answer session will follow the talk. Participation is free of charge.

As seating is limited, registrations will be accepted on a first-come, first-served basis.

For registration, call 98410 30040

Get your clothes redyed

Tula Organic Clothing, a not-for-profit, is conducting various events at Spaces, Elliots Beach Road, Besant Nagar, on June 14; 10 a.m. onwards.

There will be live demo and hands on workshop of Tula's wholistic value chain covering ginning, hand spinning, weaving, natural dyeing, block printing, crochet, eco printing, hand painting and mending.

Shoppers can bring their garments and get them (re)died or get eco printing or hand painting done. One can also buy new kora fabric or garments.

Registration is a must to participate in the workshops.

For details, call 80561 63560/ 98947 81318

Songs of the 70s

Satangi's next presentation ‘We Love 70s - II’ will be held on June 14 from 5:45 p.m. at Chinmaya Heritage Centre, Chetpet. This programme will feature memorable songs of 1970s from movies like Julie, Bobby, Kabhi Kabhi, Yaadon Ki Baaraat, Kati Patang, Don, Caravan, Hare Rama Hare Krishna, Abhimaan, Sharmilee and Chitchor.

The programme will be presented by Promod, Smriti and Ramya supported by a live orchestra.

Tickets for this event are priced at ₹1000, ₹600 and ₹300 and will be home delivered on calling 9884778073.

Fiftieth show of Gopi Funchurian

Badava Gopi will celebrate this milestone on June 20 at the Music Academy

Popular actor, mimicry artist, and stand-up comedian Badava Gopi will be celebrating the 50th performance of “Gopi Funchurian”, a unique stand-up comedy and mimicry show, on June 20 at 7 p.m. at the Music Academy.

Unlike other conventional stand-up comedy sessions, this will offer entertainment for the whole family, said a release.

The 90-minute show will feature humour, mimicry, storytelling, sound effects, celebrity voice recreations, cricket-inspired moments, and amusing real-life incidents from Gopi's life journey.

In a release, Badava Gopi said, “Mobile phones and YouTube videos cannot recreate the energy, laughter, and atmosphere that audiences experience live watching Gopi Funchurian. The show is to be felt, and enjoyed together as a family.”

The 90-minute show will start at 7 p.m. Tickets are available on BookMyShow.

For details, call 9962886000

Website: www.badavagopi.com



YOCee invites applications for Student Reporter Programme



Those in the age group of 11 to 17 can apply for this one-year programme

Chennai-based news website for children YOCee.in has announced the launch of its 20th year Student Reporter Programme. Designed to provide young students with an opportunity to learn basic news reporting skills and get published online at <https://yocce.in>, this programme is open for those in classes VI to XII. Only 25 students would be enrolled, said a press release.

After a briefing session, students will have the chance to learn on the job, work on story ideas and report on their neighbourhood. Occasional review meetings will be held during the year to ensure that each student is on track with their assignments. The student will report for one year, from June 2026

to May 2027. Upon successful completion of the required number of assignments, student reporters will receive a certificate at the end of the year.

No fee is charged for this programme.

The programme aims to provide invaluable news reporting experience to high school children. In the previous years, select news reports by YOCee's student reporters have been featured on international youth media websites. The reporters get the opportunity to participate in such projects regularly.

Apply online before June 17, 2026 at <https://yocce.in/become-a-yocce-student-reporter-applications-open-for-2026-27/>

Free computer courses in Mylapore

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan's Gandhi Institute of Computer Education and Information Technology Centre at Mylapore imparts free computer education to the educated unemployed youth belonging to the economically backward section of the society. The Bhavan is offering this selfless service to deserving students in various Job Oriented Computer Courses like MS-Office with Tally and DTP. These courses have helped many students to secure employment at various levels, said a release. Senior citizens can now take Microsoft Word, Excel and Internet Courses. Last date for collection and submission of filled application forms is June 29. For more details contact in person. The centre is at #18-22, East Mada Street, Mylapore. Phone 24611312, 24643420

Chennai cannot do without air-conditioners, but their run time can be reduced if one designed their living space green and topped it with soft furnishings that have the visible imprint of nature. Here are roadside conversations with makers of bamboo and *vetiver* curtains

Rooting for green cooling systems

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

At the time of writing this (for the times-tamp-obsessed: the afternoon of June 11), the sun has been served a memorandum of suspension for its obnoxious behaviour in the past few days. An overcast sky has ensured the fiery orb stays out of work. Clearly a reprieve from what was an unusually harsh beginning to June, generally known as the pre-monsoon season even in the sun's long-held fiefdom, Chennai. Just as a lioness would deal an overly exuberant cub a surprise paw swipe, the joy could be short-lived for the Chennai people. Put it down to climate change, the weather has the vacillating mind of a Hamlet, and so it can be hot again before you know it. And it might not be too late still to "insulate" your house with cost-effective, heat-reducing traditional props. In any case, the benefits would carry over to the next summer and the ones beyond.

Here is a cherrypicked solution, one lying under one's feet. It is curtains made of *vetiver* (*chrysopogon zizanioides*), an aromatic perennial grass native to India that comes with an air of reverence, its fragrant roots occupying the front row in pujas. Off the religious altar, it is patronised for its cooling properties. When woven into curtains, *vetiver* comes into its own. A recommendation not to be ignored: *vetiver* curtains (also known as *khus* curtains) can be teamed with bamboo curtains for coverage of greater surface area, factoring in cost, the former taking a slightly oversized bite out of the wallet, and maintenance, the former again being the difficult one.

Why these nature-based solutions, NbS as they call them? This poser needs to be put to those who make a livelihood out of making these curtains. Enter S. Jagadeeshwaran and Nagarajan, who along with their teams, work by the roadside in Alwarpet and Adyar respectively, ironically soaking up the sun to help



people stay shielded from it.

With some assistance, a *vetiver* curtain can cut out the heat to some extent. Jagadeeshwaran explains that sprinkling approximately half a litre of water on the *vetiver* screens every morning and evening helps maintain a cool atmosphere, while the moist roots release a natural earthy aroma. "*Vetiver* stands out not just for its cooling properties but also for its herbal and medicinal benefits," says Jagadeeshwaran, owner of the family-run Jagadeeshwaran Bamboo Works on TTK Road. Jagadeeshwaran makes *vetiver* curtains too.

With a life span of approximately two years and costing

around ₹200 per square foot, *vetiver* curtains, says Jagadeeshwaran, can be an ally in keeping the sun in check. Let us not hoodwink ourselves into the outrageous, even hare-brained idea that *vetiver* or for that matter bamboo can replace technology-based cooling systems (aka fans and air-conditioners).

Along with sustainable design of the house, these natural curtains can reduce the use of air conditioners, thereby resulting in savings on the power bill. But the house has to be prepared for them. They would fare better in a house with a generous provision for cross-ventilation. They do not so much cool a space as

keep unwanted stuff such as too much sunlight and pollutants out of it. Having said that, the water-sprinkled *vetiver* curtains do bring in a whiff of cool air, but only so much.

Their environmentally friendly nature should be a strong incentive to pair them with tech-based cooling solutions.

Bamboo versus vetiver

Nagarajan, a maker of bamboo as well as *vetiver* curtains in Adyar (near the Aavin parlour park) is a believer in *vetiver* curtains, but tends to bat longer for bamboo curtains. From a design perspective, bamboo curtains stand out. With those roots, *vetiver* curtains can resemble the inside of an angler's worm box. In contrast, the neat lines of the bamboo strips, horizontal, vertical or cross-stitched, make the curtains aesthetically more pleasing.

"Available in a range of colours and finishes, bamboo curtains can complement different architectural styles while helping lower indoor temperatures" Nagarajan adds. Then, the cost equation. Nagarajan notes bamboo is also the more economical option, costing around ₹100 per square foot, against the price of ₹200 per square foot *vetiver* curtains come at. He adds that bamboo products are particularly popular among resorts, hotels and homeowners looking to combine functionality with visual appeal, whereas *vetiver* curtains are predominantly preferred by individual households seeking a traditional cooling solution. With electricity tariffs ever on the rise and heatwaves becoming more stinging, Chennai residents should not ignore these traditional options. Beyond being money-wise, this would signify a return to a sustainable practice that was once the norm, and now takes an article such as this to remind ourselves of their continuing relevance.

S. Jagadeeshwaran can be contacted at 9841565239/9003183916 and Nagarajan at 9941538328.

'Building design key to effectiveness of bamboo and vetiver curtains'

Architect and co-founder of Design Co Lab, Pavithra Sriram on when these traditional curtains, which she clubs among "materials that breathe", can be effective:

"The curtain system itself, whether it is a *vetiver* curtain or a bamboo curtain, is the last step of this entire spectrum. You are looking at a building that has to be designed in such a way that there is cross ventilation. Unless you do that, your reliance on air-conditioners is not going to stop. One *vetiver* curtain in an extremely developer-built apartment that lacks cross ventilation cannot suddenly make for Ooty climate. The entire building needs to respond to the local context. It is important not to look at these things as topical, band-aid solutions. They need to be understood as part of a holistic approach. The entire building environment has to work together. When that happens, elements such as bamboo curtains, *vetiver* screens and other traditional materials can play a meaningful role in improving comfort and reducing dependence on mechanical cooling systems."

Follow these green imperatives

A resource for the Environment Month: anyone planning a tree plantation drive would do well to heed these words of wisdom from groups that got onto the right path after a few missteps

LIFFY THOMAS

‘Get a declaration from the site owner’

In 2014, when Thuvakkam began its journey, the first project had to do with the greening of a patch on a campus. But as luck would have it, that green patch eventually gave way to a building with classrooms.

Lesson learnt: extract a promise from the owners of the patch, whether government or private, that the patch will stay green. But the same challenge has dogged us through the years, particularly where government-owned sites are concerned: there is no telling what will become of a patch that has been given a dash of green.

Recently, at a public park where we had undertaken a greening initiative, the government constructed an anganwadi, resulting in the removal of trees. Imagine our disappointment! For an ongoing project at a parcel of land owned by the Southern Railway, we have got a written assurance that the land will not be touched for five to eight years.

Krishna Kumar Suresh, founder, Thuvakkam

‘Make them allies’

After a plantation exercise at a government school in Puducherry, the headmaster called me days later to say that many of the saplings were missing. The needle of suspicion pointed to the students. I was shocked to learn that students had taken the saplings of fruit-bearing trees probably to grow them in their own backyard.

Lesson learnt: make them allies. This incident taught us the need to start a ‘Green Brigade’ where we give each child a free fruit sapling. These plants find their way into homes of students and other public spaces where they are nurtured by children. Under the Green Brigade initiative, we have so far given away many saplings.

To promote a sense of ownership, we started the practice of having a name board created at every plantation site. This has the name of the farmer responsible for nurturing the plants along with details of the plant species. But at one drive, I noticed that many saplings were left to wither in a corner, unplanted, as the people entrusted with the job of planting them had left the scene. After this episode, we make it a point to have the nameboard put up only after all the saplings are planted.

Prasiddhi Singh, founder, Prasiddhi Forest Foundation

‘Keep a backup plan in place’

We had planted more than 8,000 saplings on a 24-acre land owned by SIPCOT, Vallam Vadagal only to find that more than 60 per cent of them withered one harsh summer. The local civic body was providing water for these saplings and due to some reason the supply stopped affecting some young plants that needed water the most. Jackfruit and a medical plant used for cancer were the biggest victims.

Lesson learnt: one cannot rely on any institution for the continued survival of the saplings one had planted. So, before taking up such a massive exercise, have a Plan B, one particularly geared to meeting the saplings’ water needs. Knowing the soil, the groundwater table and the kind of trees planted is important.

At the same OSR site where we are growing a Miyawaki forest and raising a regular plantation, we have now arranged a 20,000 litre tank with a private supplier refilling it. We have replaced the lost plants with new ones.

Lt. Col. N. Thiagarajan, general secretary, Mastermind Foundation

‘Let go; or hang on till they see reason’

As part of their CSR initiative, a corporate had given us a list of plants they wanted us to grow and maintain, but a majority of those plants were not suited for Chennai’s climate. We tried explaining to the corporate how the location and the soil type plays an important role in the growth of plants but they would not listen.

In another case, an amusement park on East Coast Road wanted us to plant aesthetic-looking trees on their property. The problem with such trees is that they may not necessarily have a long life span and are not of much help to the ecosystem.

Lesson learnt: these two scenarios taught us to choose between two wise approaches. One, drop the project. Two, take up the work but make sure the client sees reason as you progress with the project.

Sreekumar Nair, founder, TREES

A second chance for everyday things

As a two-day garment mending workshop by Samposhan ends today, a close look at Chennai's repair culture provides cause for some celebration and also reasons to revitalise efforts to promote it

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Wire it right

At a time when malfunctioning appliances are often discarded with little thought, Repair Café Chennai is championing an alternative ethos, one that prioritises repair and recirculation.

Launched in October 2024 by Meenalochani S, founder member of Repair Café Chennai, the initiative traces its roots to the Repair Café movement started in Bengaluru by Purna Sarkar. The first Chennai session was held in the portico of Meenalochani's home, bringing together friends and their children for a hands-on introduction to repairing everyday objects. "It felt very much needed for every child as part of the skills they should grow up with," says Meenalochani.

The inaugural event featured stations for carpentry, cycle repair, and electrical and electronic repairs. Over time, however, the Chennai chapter evolved into a series of workshops focused primarily on

electrical and electronics repair. "The electrical and electronics section caught up with us because we found good mentors for it who were willing to continue the journey," she says. "My daughter got to open up the devices and identify the problem herself. Now she knows electronic goods can be repaired instead of simply buying new ones," says one of the participants.

Since then the collective has conducted workshops with a school in Besant Nagar, collaborated twice with Goethe Institute, and organised sessions in public spaces across the city. Most participants have been homeschoolers, with some families travelling from Puducherry



During a session at Repair Cafe Chennai.



Operating from his main outlet near Thirumangalam in Anna Nagar, with branches in Mogappair, T. Nagar, Ambattur and Padappai, Aasai Muthu restores saris damaged by age, wear and accident. Torn fabrics, damaged borders, colour bleeding caused by rainwater, rodent-inflicted damage and faded hues are among the most common problems brought to his workshop.

The craft is a "hand-me-down" to Aasai Muthu. "My grandfather and father were both weavers. From childhood, I was surrounded by saris and weaving work," he says. "Even now, I can easily identify different types of zari and borders."

His clientele ranges from homemakers seeking to preserve treasured possessions to actors and other prominent personalities. Wedding silks and heirloom saris account for a significant portion of the work he undertakes, particularly from customers in Mylapore. "Many people bring saris that belonged to their mothers or grandmothers. They do not want to throw them away because there are memories attached to them," he says.

Restoration charges typically range from ₹500 to ₹2,000, depending on the complexity of the work involved. While the repair itself generally takes three to four days, the entire process extends to six to eight days, including approximately two days each for collection and delivery. Customers may either visit the workshop or schedule a home visit, during which Muthu personally assesses the sari's condition. As part of the service, every restored sari is returned with a complimentary dry-cleaning treatment, helping revive its appearance and finish.

One of the more unusual assignments he recalls involved a government official who wanted the border from one sari painstakingly removed and attached to another. Such requests, he says, underscore the sentimental value that many customers continue to place on their garments.

Yet, Aasai Muthu has observed a gradual decline in the culture of repair. "Nowadays, many people prefer to sell old saris and buy new ones. Earlier," he says. The challenge becomes even greater when dealing with saris that are decades old. "Repairing a sari that is 30 or 40 years old requires a lot of patience. We cannot bring back the original material completely, but we can restore it and make it wearable again," he says.

Call Aasai Muthu at 6380563972

to attend repeatedly.

Through pre-registered sessions lasting three to four hours, participants learn troubleshooting, continuity testing, soldering and basic appliance repair under the guidance of volunteer mentors.

Fees range from ₹500 to ₹1,000.

The initiative also sustains an active WhatsApp community where participants seek repair advice and share resources. Looking beyond workshops, the group is working to build a gig-employment network connecting skilled repairers with those seeking repair services. "Our mission is to create earning opportunities, empower skilled workers, and connect them with people who need reliable repair solutions," says Meenalochani.

Instagram - @repaircafe.tiruandchennai

Stitching memories

When a treasured sari is torn, faded or damaged, Chennai-based sari repairer Aasai Muthu is often the person customers turn to.

With over 45 years of experience, Muthu has built a niche business around restoring saris that hold sentimental, cultural and monetary value.



The last day of a restoration workshop

Samposhan, the sustainability enterprise based in Adambakkam and founded by Mamta Jain, has brought together environmental consciousness and creativity through a two-day mending workshop in Besant Nagar. Titled "Pause. Mend. Reuse.", the event (June 13 and 14) encourages participants to repair and reimagine worn garments, extending their lifespan while underscoring Samposhan's broader mission of reducing textile waste and promoting a circular economy. Through hands-on sessions, attendees learn mindful mending techniques and explore ways to give cherished pieces a new lease of life, demonstrating how a simple repair can be a small but significant act of sustainable living.

Instagram - @thesamposhan

North Chennai school toppers encouraged to become lifelong learners

Twenty-two girl students who excelled in board examinations were felicitated

Twenty-two girl students from schools across North Chennai who excelled in the recent Class X and Class XII public examinations were felicitated at a programme organised by Chevalier T. Thomas Elizabeth College for Women, Perambur on June 10.

The event sought to recognise academic achievement while encouraging students to view examination success as the beginning of a lifelong journey of learning, reading and personal growth, said a press release. Students from schools in Perambur, Erukkanchery, Vyasarpadi, Pulianthope, Villivakkam, Kodungaiyur, Ayanavaram, Vepery and Red Hills participated in the programme along with their parents and teachers.

Principal S. Sridevi said academic success is often the result of sustained effort, discipline and family support, and encouraged students to continue learning beyond the classroom.



Students with the certificates they were given.

She urged students to cultivate the habit of engaging with books regularly and to make use of public and digital libraries.

The principal highlighted the need for responsible digital citizenship and advised students to use technology and social media as tools for learning, knowledge-sharing and professional development.

Writer and editor Cholai Tamileniyar spoke on the transformative role of reading in individual and social development. Encouraging students to visit libraries regularly, he said reading broadens perspectives, nurtures curiosity and helps young people engage meaningfully

with society. He urged students not to allow economic or social circumstances to limit their aspirations and encouraged them to pursue higher education with confidence, added the release.

Among those honoured were Harini R. of Don Bosco Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Erukkanchery, and Aishwarya Letchumi P. of Kaligi Ranganathan Montford Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Perambur, who emerged as the highest-scoring higher secondary students among the participants. They were presented with copies of North Chennai, a volume published by Chevalier T. Thomas

Elizabeth College for Women on the educational history and heritage of the region.

All participating students received certificates of merit, books and a cash award in recognition of their academic achievements.

Sudha Srikanth, placement director of the college, addressed the students on employability and future career readiness, while Alima Zehera, head of the Department of Psychology, spoke on mental well-being, self-development and the importance of continuously upgrading skills through higher education and professional learning platforms.

Three schools get RO water plants

The Inner Wheel Club of Chennai Central Elite installed three RO Water Plants under its flagship 'Kind Hearts Project - Boond: A Drop of Life', aimed at providing access to clean, safe, and healthy drinking water to children and the community.

The installations were carried out at Chennai Noon Meals Centre, KK Nagar; North Madras Social Service Middle School, Old Washermenpet; and North Madras Social Service Nursery & Primary School, Old Washermenpet.

The initiative was supported by POCL Enterprises Limited, K. S. Ranka Jain Foundation, and the Inner Wheel Club of Chennai Central Elite.

Session on gender justice

Justice Basheer Ahmed Sayeed College for Women and Soroptimist International Chennai Downtown organised an programme advocating gender justice.

Titled "Know Your Rights - Empowering Muslim Women," around school and college girls attended the session, says a press release.

The keynote speakers included Prabha Sridevan, retired Senior Judge of Madras High Court and Bader Sayeed, Senior Advocate and Chairperson of the SIET Group of Institutions.

Their address highlighted the rights of women under Muslim Personal Law and the Constitution of India. They also shared some real inspiring cases, adds the release. An interactive question-and-answer session was part of the programme.

Real estate firm organises celebratory event



Tirthanighai Real Estates recently celebrated its annual 'Kudumba Vizha 2026' in the city.

Held at MCC School auditorium in Chetpet, the festival brought together the firm's channel partners, employees, business associates, and their families for an evening dedicated to recognition and inspiration.

Founded by K. K. Muniyanti, the organisation's chairman, the nearly four-decade-old firm has built a strong reputation on trust.

Muniyanti reiterated the organisation's long-standing vision that every family should own a piece of land.

A major highlight at the celebration was the recognition of channel partners, team leaders, marketing managers, and employees

through a series of awards and documentary-style presentations that showcased their success stories.

The leadership team comprising K. K. Munusamy, S. Arun Kumar, K.M. Srinivasan, and K.M. Hariharan unveiled upcoming residential projects under the Tiru Thanikai Infra City and shared the organisation's vision for the future.

Best Bargains

SOFA SERVICE
ANY SOFA'S RECLINER SOFAS CUSHIONS REUPHOLSTERY
Reconditioning @ Very Moderate Charges
K.N.S.RAJAN SERVICES
76671 33233
93818 03956

MUSIC CLASSES
Online & Offline at Mandaveli (Both Kids and Adults)
❖ Carnatic music for beginners
❖ Nottuswarams
❖ Bhajans
❖ Tamil and Patriotic songs
❖ Slokas & Stotrams
NEW BATCH COMMENCES FROM JUNE
Contact: R. POOJA
+91 98402 05230

DOORSTEP CAR DETAILING
PREMIUM CAR CARE
• Foam Wash
• Interior Cleaning
• Dashboard Polish
• Tyre Care
• Wax Finish
STARTING FROM 699 RS.
WE COME TO YOUR LOCATION
CHENNAI - ALL AREAS
8668157144
@detailinghouse

To advertise in
DOWNTOWN
Contact:
UDHAYAKUMAR
81246 14787

Naturally Grown
MANGOES
BANGANAPALLI
₹150/ kg
IMAM PASAND
₹200/ kg
Transport extra
Call: 98840 14717
Life Natural Farms, Chetpet

Lift AMC Breakdown CEIG Approval
Lift ARD
New Installation
98410 33888

Departed for *another* sanctuary

V. Guruswami leaves behind a flock of admirers in naturalist circles

PRINCE FREDERICK

In the morning of June 11, if any birder in the field noticed a sudden drop in chirps verging on stillness, let them know that these birds sensed an instinctive snapping of a tie, the departure of a soul that sought to understand them selflessly. Not to make it to scientific journals and put on learned airs; nor to engage in social-media engagement farming. In their world, he discovered his own, one devoid of artificiality and filled with effortless comfort.

That morning, V. Guruswami departed for another sanctuary. A long life (he was 96), one spent with a great degree of autonomy (he bounced back to full health after a stroke in the fog end of 2011 and was in fine fettle till the last week of his life) is certainly a measure of blessing. But what was truly Guruswami's blessing was his ability to bless others with his knowledge, unconditionally without expecting anything in return. He leaves behind a flock of friends (nay more admirers than friends) at Madras Naturalists Society, a repository of local naturalist wisdom. But anyone who has known

him beyond birding field visits would instantly resist the temptation to pigeonhole him into the identity of a naturalist-birder.

The breadth of his knowledge was indisputably vast. To give an inkling, he could hold forth on the legendary kite flyers of Madras in the 1940s and in the same breath share the contents of his correspondence with Jim Corbett. He was rooted locally, deeply connected with the twin *jheels* (Manali and Madhavaram) as well as the verdant Simpson Estate in Sembium (all of them close to his former address in Thiru-Vi-Ka Nagar), but he had a global consciousness, always sharpened by a desire for knowledge, again not acquired for self-aggrandisement but to freely share with others.

His curriculum vitae would indirectly reveal how he went out of his way mining for knowledge in various fields.

"Guruswami was born on September 25, 1930, studied at CSI Kellet Higher Secondary School in Triplicane and graduated with a chemistry degree from Presidency College, Madras. He started working with the Ordinance Factory at Khamaria, Jabalpur, later moved



V. Guruswami (September 25, 1930 - June 11, 2026), truly erudite and incredibly humble.

to Addison Paints at the Simpson Estate in Sembium where he joined as a chemist and retired as a production manager."

That note is oddly familiar; one

comes across that kind of a bio all the time; only that this one is silent on an extra universe of pursuits. Silent on reams and reams on the koel vocalisation, listening in to

the male koel's plaintive calls during the breeding season, year after year.

Silent on the incredible conservation story at the Simpson Estate, where he helped protect a heronry. Silent on the trends of various bird species he had documented and shared with journalists including this reporter. And silent on the numerous notes on the drift of things in various other fields he had penned, just for his delectation and those known to him. Unfortunately, much of this information was lost in the shifting of addresses. When he was advanced in years (in the early 2010s after his almost-magical recovery from the stroke) Guruswami and three other seniors in the family took the decision to move from Thiru-Vi-Ka Nagar to a senior-friendly block of an apartment in Sholingnallur with the support of the younger relatives in the family. Guruswami remained unmarried, and enjoyed a deep connection with his family, immediate and extended, and he was the favourite uncle and grandpa, no contests there.

And it was in this space on June 11, Guruswami breathed his last, nay let out his last chirp, not far from the Pallikaralai marsh synonymous with winged residents and visitors.

Boats at Kasimedu being primed for a new innings



Fishing boats at the Kasimedu harbour are currently undergoing repair and maintenance work as fishermen prepare for their upcoming fishing operations. The works include engine servicing, welding, painting, and repairing fishing nets and equipment. The harbour has become a centre of activity with workers, mechanics, and fishermen working together to complete the repairs.

PHOTOS & TEXT: VINISHA JAIKUMAR

THEJOMAYA

Two decades of transforming students

Handwriting classes 2026-27

Before

After



93813 29450 / 94446 79773

one to one attention

24 hours duration

Cursive/Print/Speed writing

சந்திரன் ஜி ஸ்ரீராமச்சந்திரன் ஸ்வாமி துணை
ஸ்ரீ குரு விபக் ஸேனா பரஸ்
ஸ்ரீ குரு கோபேந்திர பரஸ்

“ஸ்ரீ ஞானானந்த மணி மாலை”

2026 ஜூன் 17 முதல் 21 வரை
மாலை 6-15 முதல் 8-30 வரை
நாமலங்கார்த்தனம்:
ஸ்ரீ விஜயக்குஷ்ண பாகவதர்
உபந்யாஸம்: கோவிந்தபுரம்
ஸ்ரீ பாலாஜி பாகவதர்
சுருள் பெற அனைவரும் வருக
நினைவும் ஸந்தோசமும் பூர்த்தியாகவும் ப்ரஸாத விநியோகம் உண்டாகும்